

Is Anything
too Hard for
the LORD?



Seventy-year-old Ugandan woman gives birth to twins - hospital

1 December 2023

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Danai Nesta Kupemba
BBC News



The Ugandan fertility clinic said Safina Namukwaya had become Africa's oldest mother at the age of 70

A 70-year-old woman has given birth to twins following IVF treatment, a hospital in Uganda has said.

Safina Namukwaya delivered a boy and a girl via caesarean at a fertility centre in the capital, Kampala.



Sarah's
Laughte
r

Lot's
Tragedy

God's
Providing



“Sarah laughed to herself as she thought, ‘After I am worn out and my lord is old, will I now have this pleasure?’”

Genesis 18:12, NIV





“Then the LORD said to Abraham, ‘Why did Sarah laugh and say, ‘Will I really have a child, now that I am old?’

...I will return to you at the appointed time next year, and Sarah will have a son.’

Genesis 18:13-15
Sarah was afraid, so she lied
and said, ‘I did not laugh,’
NIV,

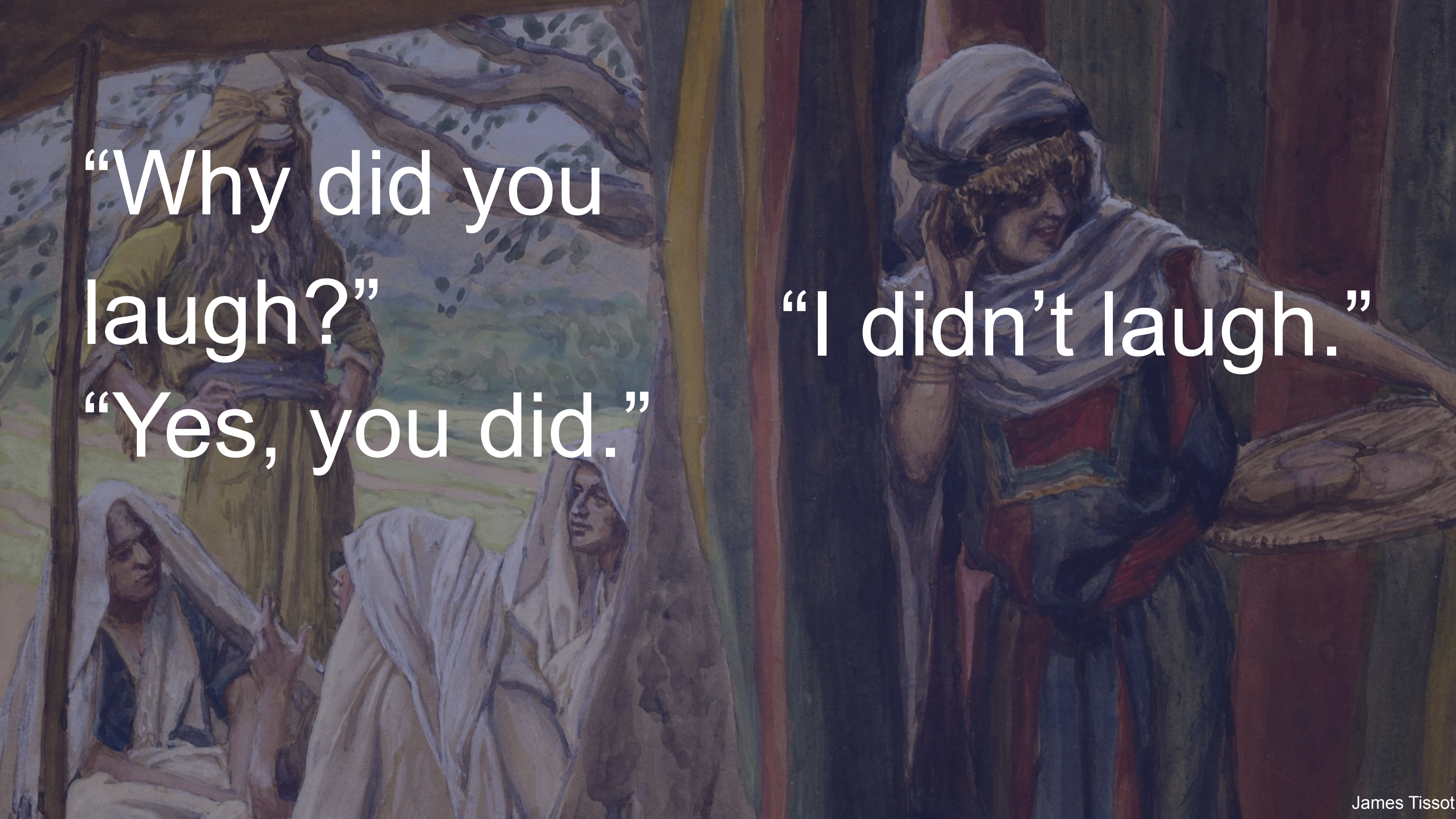
“Why did you
laugh?”





“Why did you
laugh?”

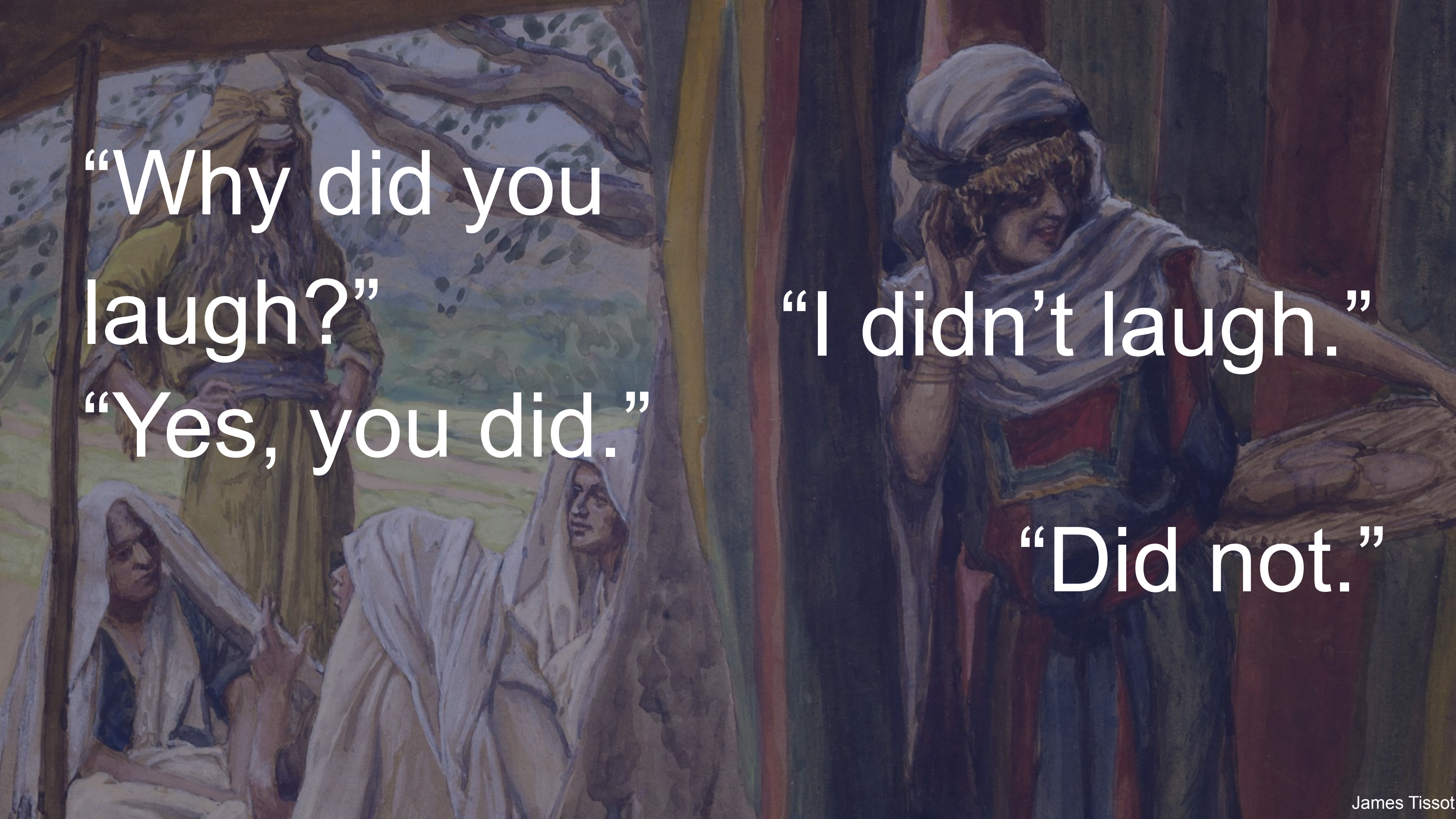
“I didn’t laugh.”



“Why did you
laugh?”

“Yes, you did.”

“I didn’t laugh.”

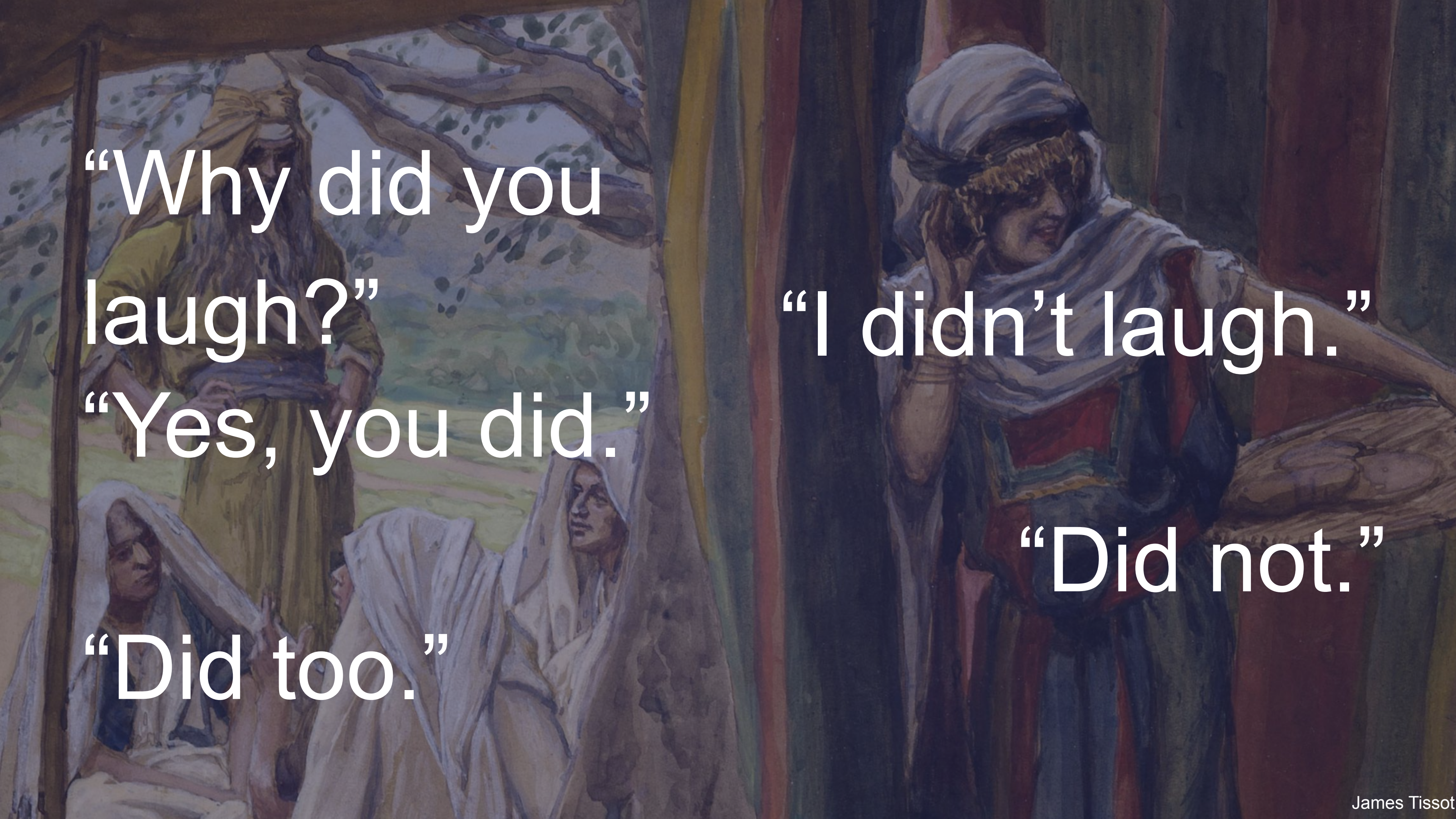


“Why did you
laugh?”

“Yes, you did.”

“I didn’t laugh.”

“Did not.”



“Why did you
laugh?”

“Yes, you did.”

“Did too.”

“I didn’t laugh.”

“Did not.”



“Is anything too
hard for the

Genesis 18:14,
LORD?”

Adonai Translated as “Lord”

YHWH Translated as “LORD”

Genesis 18

13 And the LORD said unto Abraham, Wherefore did Sarah^a laugh, saying, Shall I of a surety bear a child, which am^b old?

14 Is any thing too^a hard for the LORD? At the time appointed I will return unto thee, according to the^b time of life, and Sarah shall have a son.

THE LIVING CHRIST

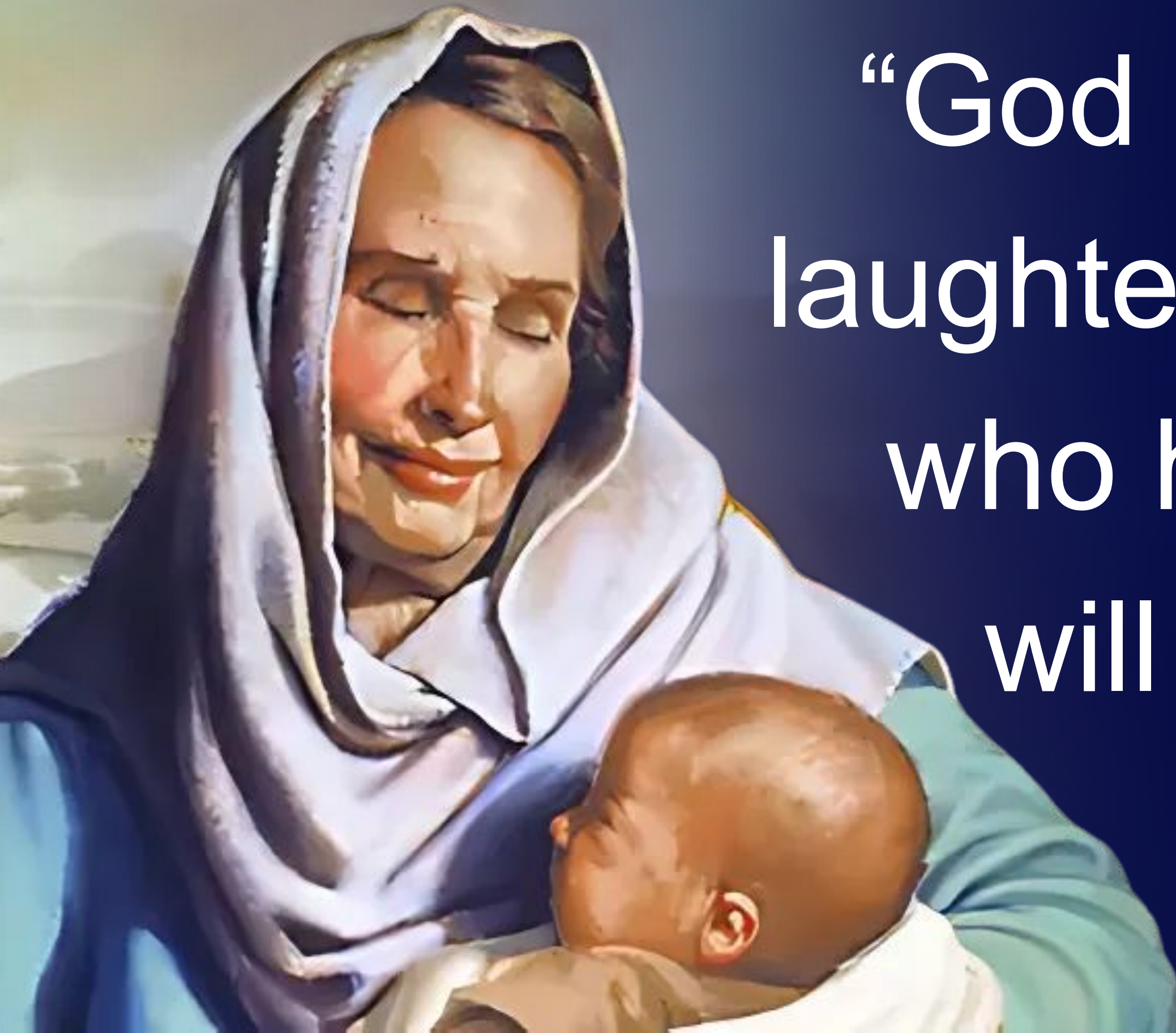
THE TESTIMONY OF THE APOSTLES

THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-DAY SAINTS

As we commemorate the birth of Jesus Christ two millennia ago, we offer our testimony of the reality of His matchless life and the infinite virtue of His great atoning sacrifice. None other has had so profound an influence upon all who have lived and will yet live upon the earth.

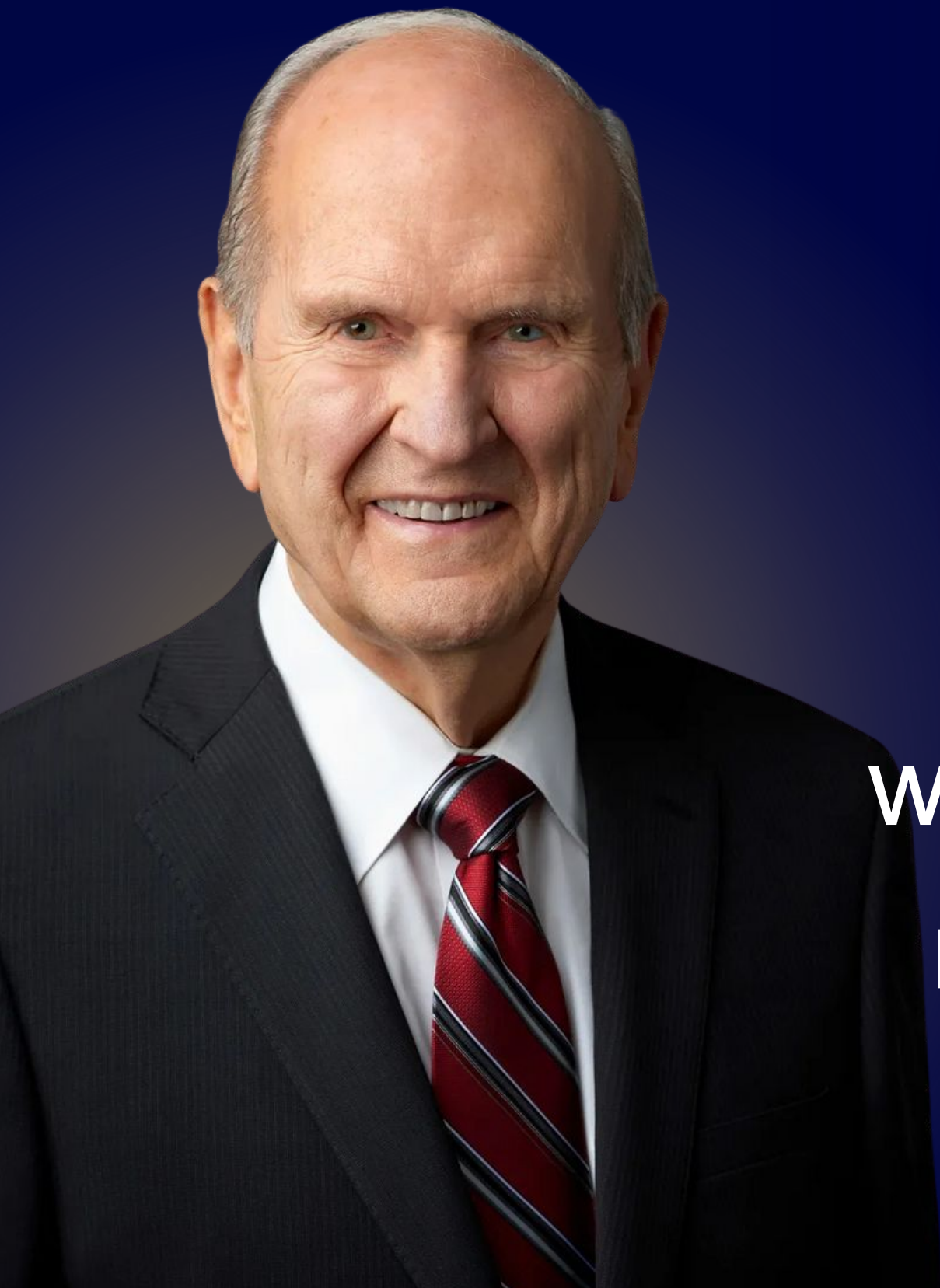
He was the Great Jehovah of the Old Testament, the Messiah of the New. Under the direction of His Father, He was the creator of the earth. “All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made” (John 1:3). Though sinless, He was baptized to fulfill all





“God has brought me
laughter, and everyone
who hears about this
will laugh with me.”
Genesis 21:6,

NIV



“Seek and expect miracles...The Lord will bless you with miracles if you believe in Him, ‘doubting nothing.’ Do the spiritual work to seek miracles.

Prayerfully ask God to help you exercise that kind of faith...Few things will accelerate your spiritual momentum more than realizing the Lord is helping you to move a mountain in your life.”

President Russell M.
Nelson

Ensign, May 2022

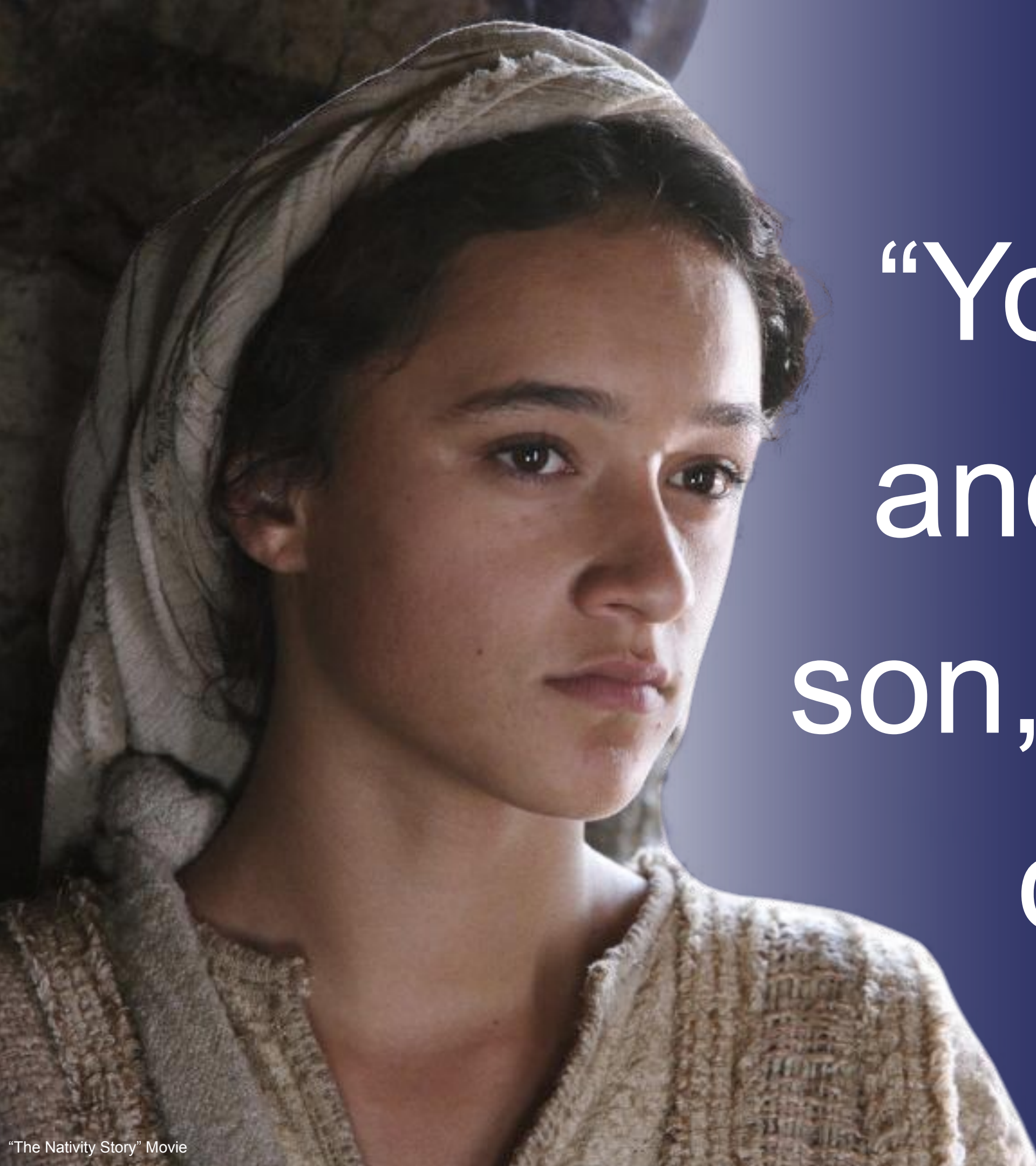
“When everything was hopeless, Abraham [and Sarah] believed anyway, deciding to live not on the basis of what [they] saw [they] couldn’t do but on what God said He would do.”





“By faith even Sarah, who
was past childbearing age,
was enabled to bear
children because **she**
considered him faithful who
had made
the promise!”

Hebrews 11:11,
NIV



“You will conceive
and give birth to a
son, and you are to
call him Jesus.”
Luke 1:31,

NIV

A woman with dark hair, wearing a light-colored headscarf and a textured, light-colored garment, is shown in a close-up. She is looking off to the side with a contemplative expression. The background is a solid dark blue.

“How will this
be, since I am
a virgin?”

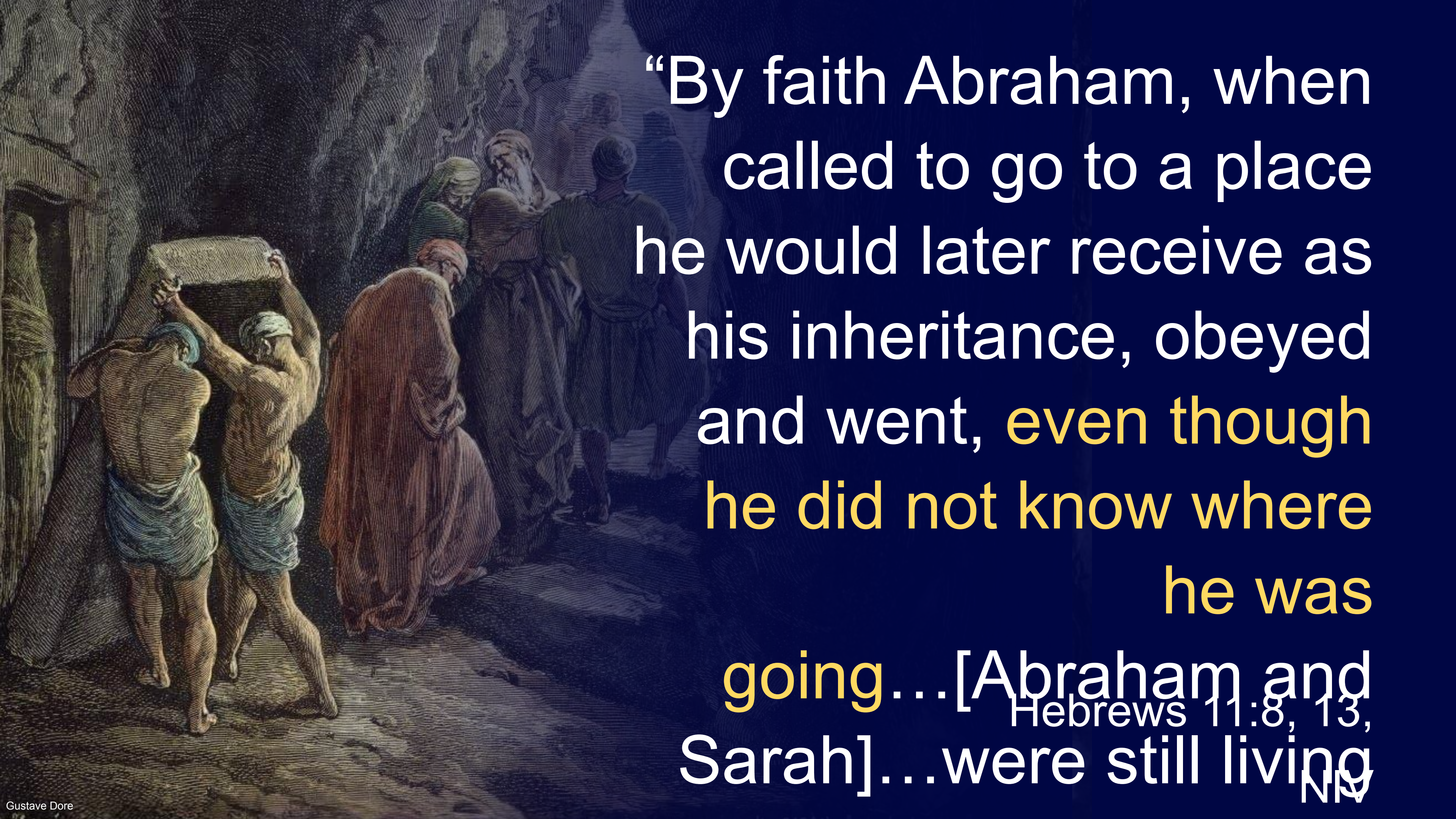
Luke 1:34,

NIV



“For **nothing**
is impossible
with God.”
Luke 1:37,

NIV



“By faith Abraham, when
called to go to a place
he would later receive as
his inheritance, obeyed
and went, **even though**
he did not know where
he was

going... [Abraham and
Hebrews 11:8, 13,
Sarah]...were still living

“They did not
receive the things
promised; they only
saw them and
welcomed them
from a distance,
admitting that they
were foreigners and
strangers on earth.”



“Will you sweep
away the
righteous with
the wicked?”

Genesis 18:23,

NIV

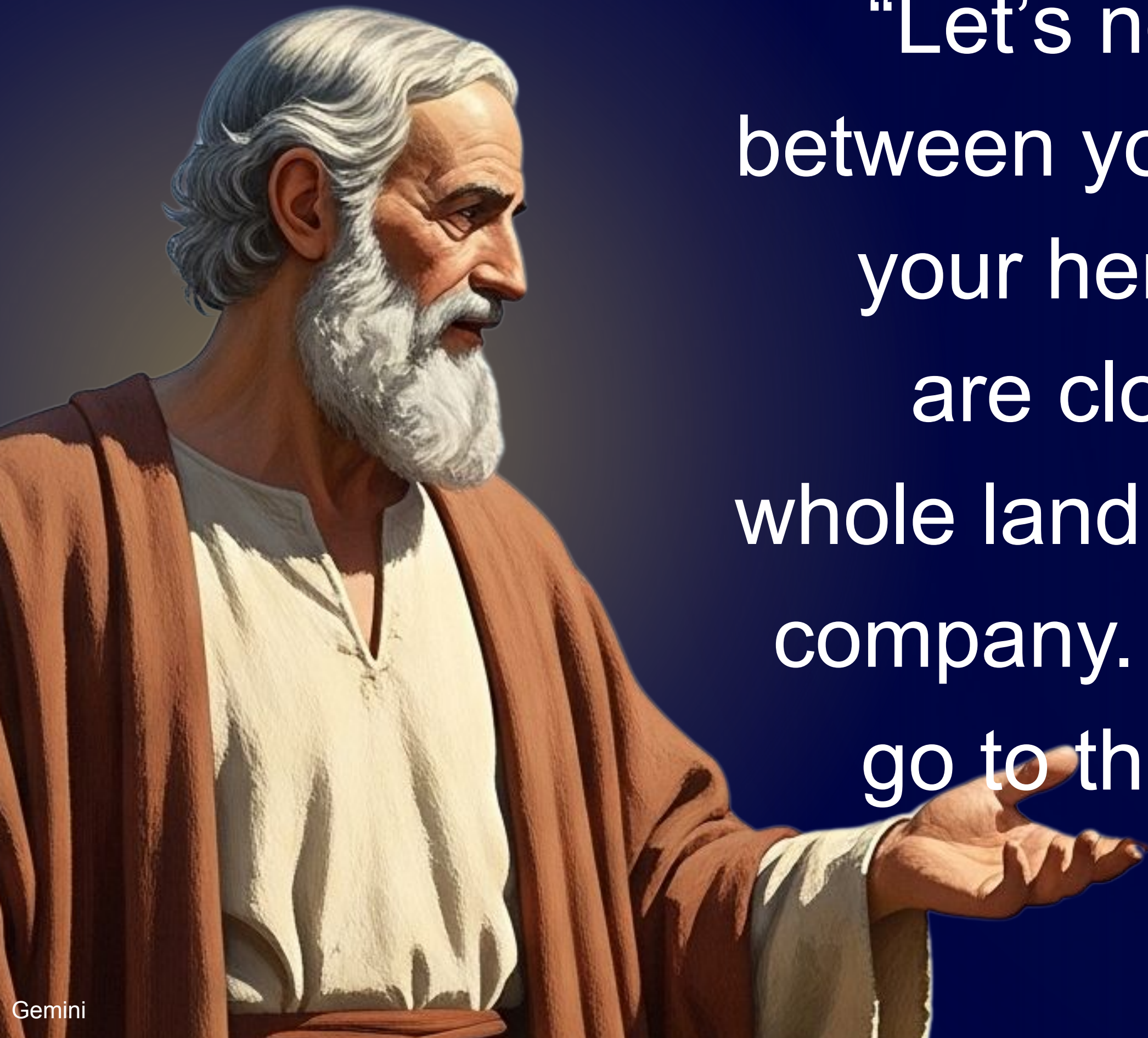




Sarah's
Laughte
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Lot's
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God's
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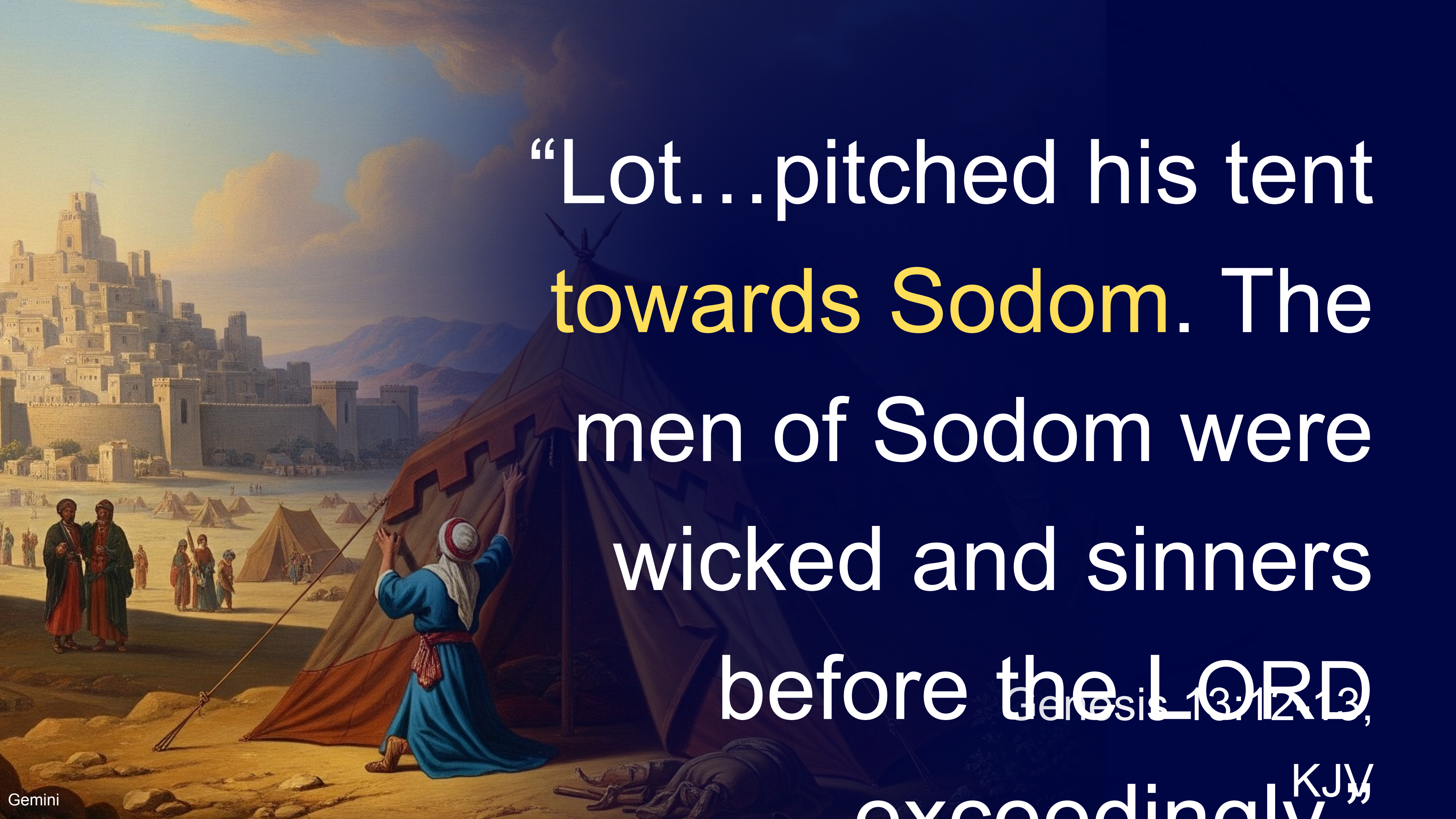


“Let’s not have any quarreling
between you and me, or between
your herders and mine, for we
are close relatives. Is not the
whole land before you? Let’s part
company. If you go to the left, I’ll
go to the right; if you go to the
right, I’ll go to the left.”

Genesis 13:8-9

NIV



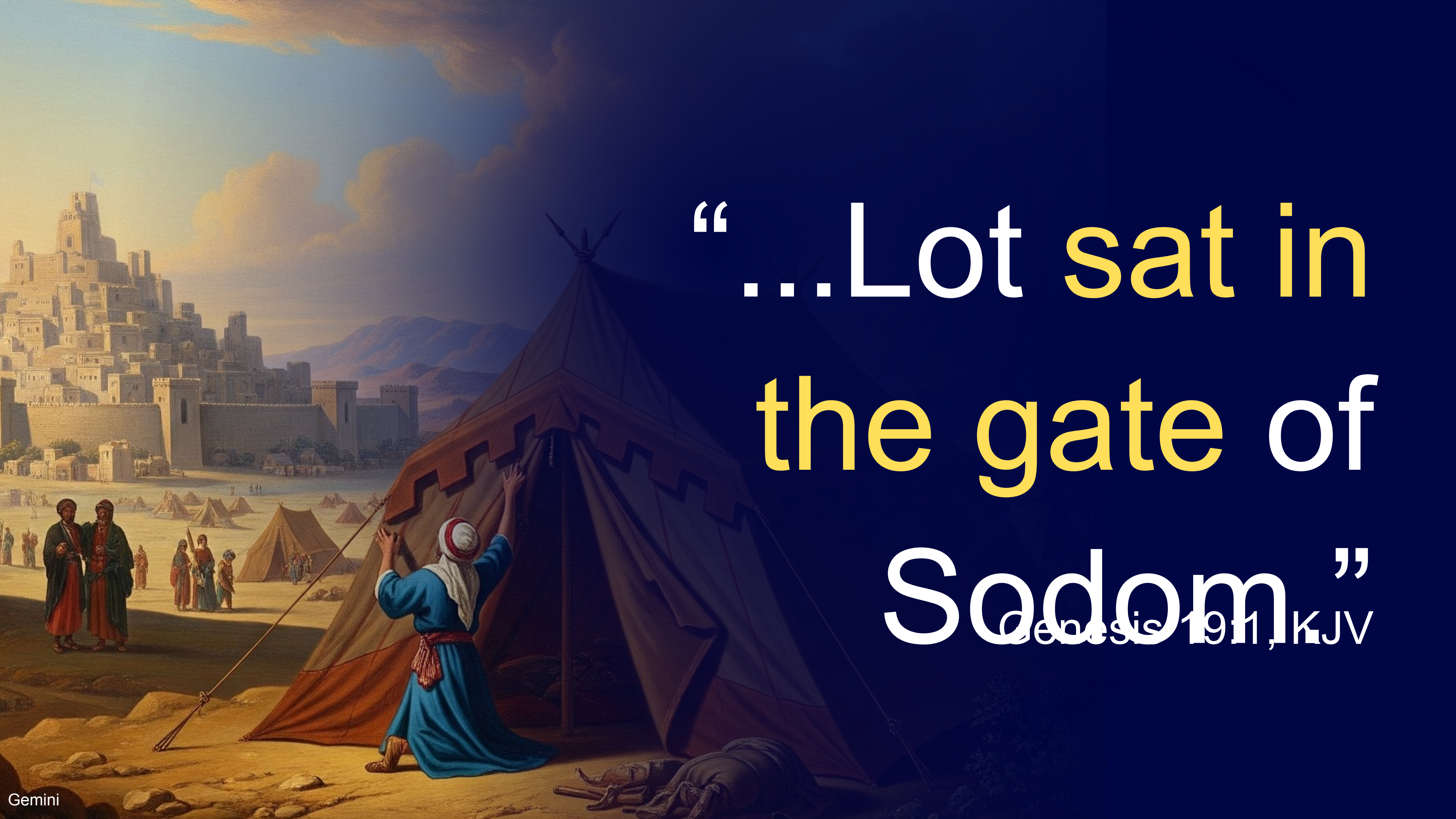


“Lot...pitched his tent
towards Sodom. The
men of Sodom were
wicked and sinners
before the LORD,
Genesis 13:12, 13,
KJV,
exceedingly”



“Lot...dwelt
in Sodom.”

Genesis 14:12, KJV



“...Lot sat in
the gate of
Sodom.”
Genesis 19:1, KJV

Journal of Personality and Social Psychology Monograph Supplement

Volume 9, No. 2, Part 2

June 1968

ATTITUDINAL EFFECTS OF MERE EXPOSURE¹

ROBERT B. ZAJONC
University of Michigan

The hypothesis is offered that mere repeated exposure of the individual to a stimulus object enhances his attitude toward it. By "mere" exposure is meant a condition making the stimulus accessible to the individual's perception. Support for the hypothesis consists of 4 types of evidence, presented and reviewed: (a) the correlation between affective connotation of words and word frequency; (b) the effect of experimentally manipulated frequency of exposure upon the affective connotation of nonsense words and symbols; (c) the correlation between word frequency and the attitude to their referents; (d) the effects of experimentally manipulated frequency of exposure on attitude. The relevance for the exposure-attitude hypothesis of the exploration theory and of the semantic satiation findings were examined.

On February 27, 1967, the Associated Press
telling story from Corvallis,

exposure" is meant a condition which just
makes the given stimulus accessible to the in-
dividual's perception.
the hypothesis seems to be in
(fami-







Gemini



Gemini

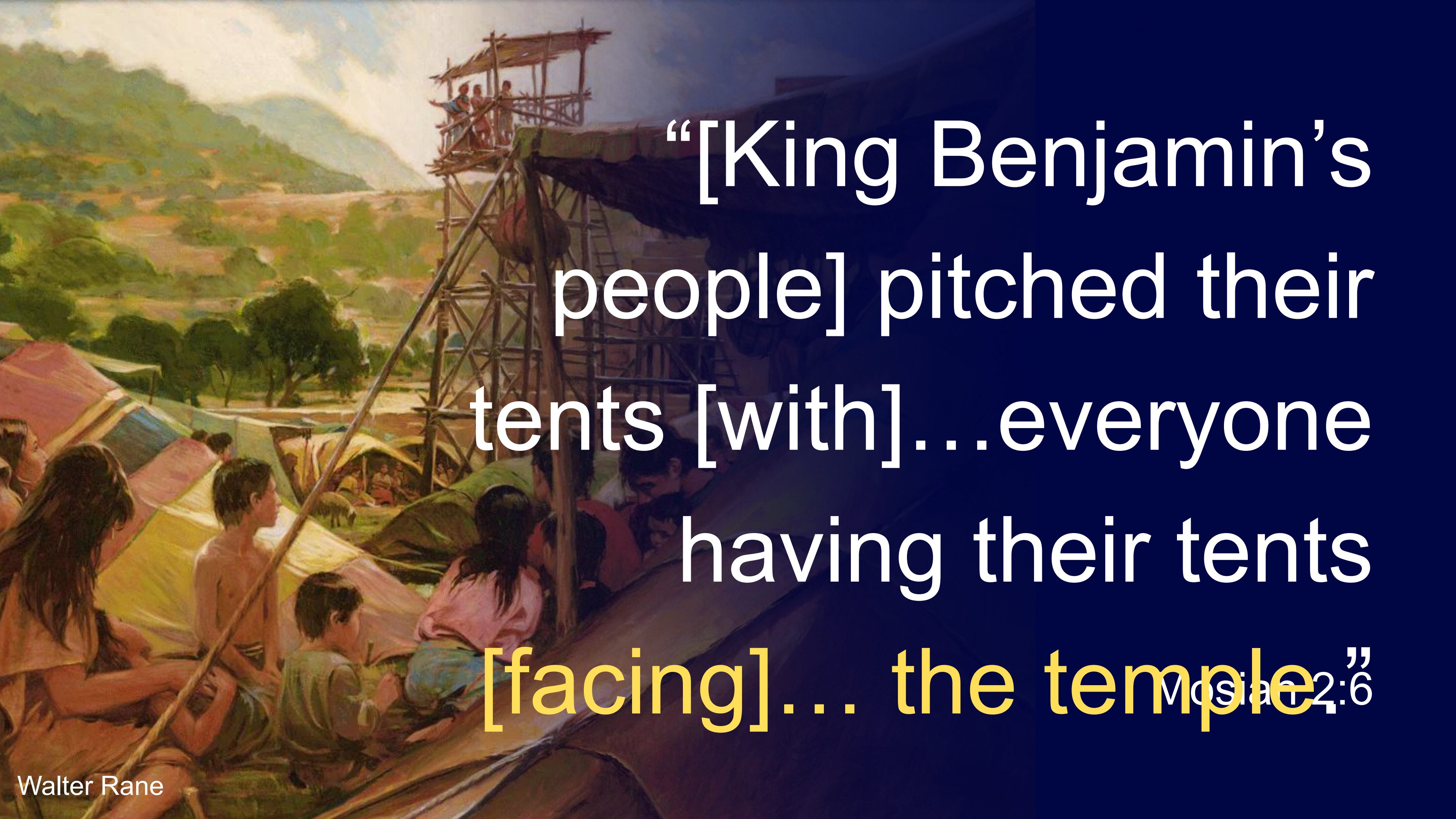
“The eye is the
lamp of the body. If
your eyes are
healthy, your whole
body will be full of

Matthew 6:22

NIV

“If, however,





“[King Benjamin’s
people] pitched their
tents [with]...everyone
having their tents
[facing]... the temple.”

Mosiah 2:6



1. Be careful what you look
at



1. Be careful what you look

2. ~~at~~ Don't delay when God speaks



Scripture Helps:
Old Testament

DECEMBER 2025

“The Joseph Smith Translation of Genesis 19 clearly describes the actions of Lot’s daughters as wicked. The two young women seemed to understand that they were doing something wrong, as they planned to make their father drunk so he would not realize what was happening. Many naturally wonder why this account is included in the

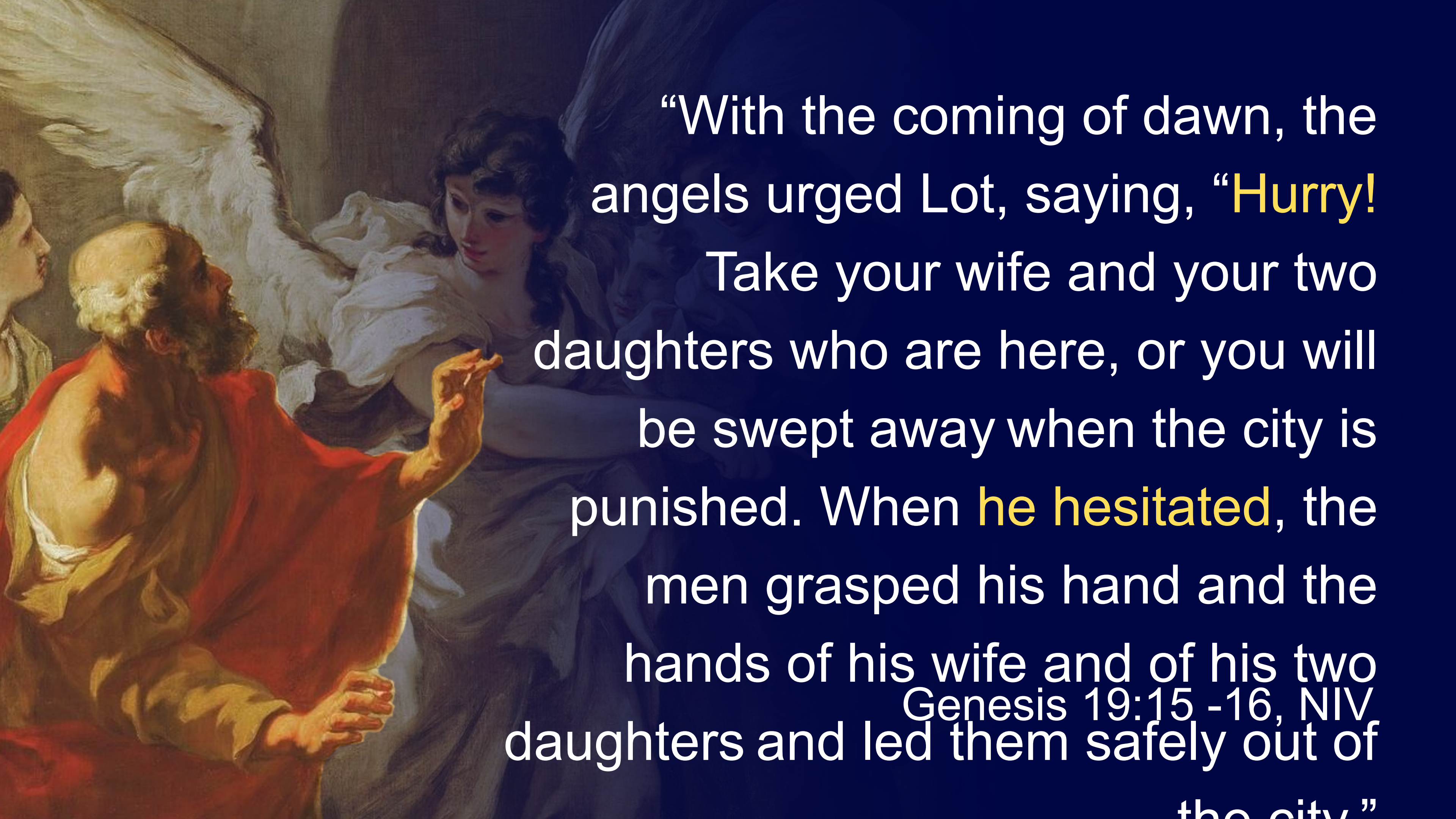


Scripture Helps:
Old Testament

DECEMBER 2025

“Like many stories in Genesis, it explains origins. The children conceived in this story were said to be the ancestors of the Moabites and the Ammonites.

These nations would later interact with Israel, sometimes in conflict. This origin account is unfavorable to these people, which might have fueled



“With the coming of dawn, the angels urged Lot, saying, “**Hurry!** Take your wife and your two daughters who are here, or you will be swept away when the city is punished. When **he hesitated**, the men grasped his hand and the hands of his wife and of his two daughters and led them safely out of the city.”

Genesis 19:15 -16, NIV



- Abraham **runs** to meet them

- (Genesis 18:2)

- Abraham **hurries** into the tent to ask Sarah to prepare food

- (Genesis 18:6)

- Abraham **runs** to the herd to prepare a calf

“Remember Lot’s wife.”

Luke 17:32



“Flee for your lives!
Don't look back, and
don't stop anywhere in
the plain! Flee to the
mountains or you will
be swept away!”

Genesis 19:17
NIV



“Lot’s wife
looked back, and
she became a
pillar of salt.”

Genesis 19:26,

NIV

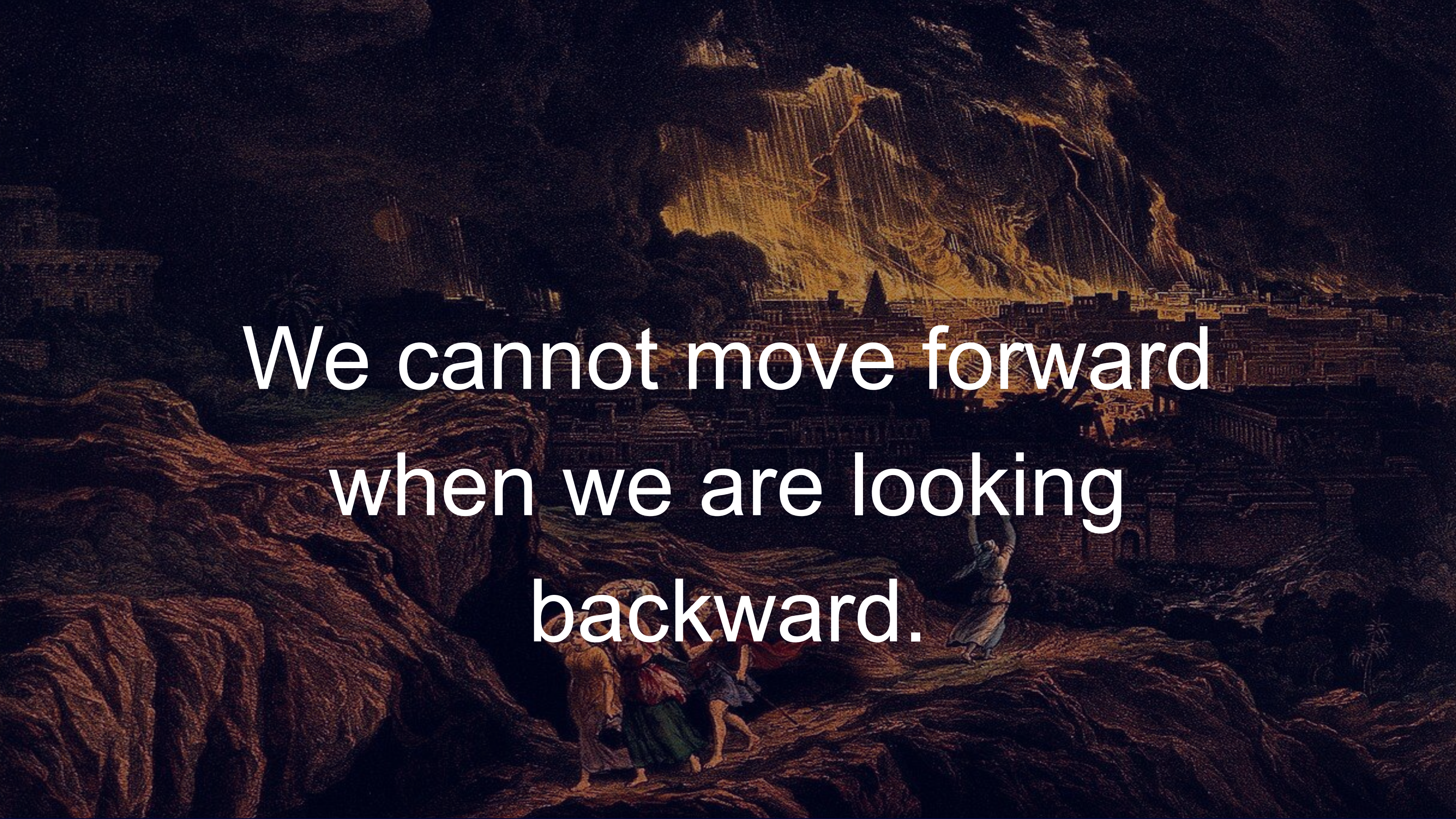


“Apparently what was wrong with Lot’s wife was that she wasn’t just *looking* back; in her heart she wanted to *go* back. So it isn’t just that she looked back; she looked back longingly. In short, **her attachment to the past**

President Jeffery R. Holland

“Remember Lot’s Wife,” Jan 2009
outweighed her confidence in the future.”



A dramatic painting depicting a city at night, likely Jerusalem, with a massive fire or eruption on a cliff in the background. In the foreground, several figures are walking on a rocky path, looking back towards the city. The scene is dark and atmospheric, with a strong contrast between the dark foreground and the bright, glowing fire in the background.

We cannot move forward
when we are looking
backward.



“I focus on this
one thing:
Forgetting the past
and looking
forward to what
lies ahead.”

Philippians 3:13,
NLT

“When [repentance is sincere] and when honest effort is being made to progress, we are guilty of the greater sin if we keep remembering and recalling and rebashing someone with their earlier mistakes—and that “someone” might be ourselves. We can be so hard on ourselves, often much more so than with others!”

President Jeffery R. Holland
“Remember Lot’s Wife,” Jan

2009



“Now, like the Anti-Nephi-Lehies
of the Book of Mormon, bury
your weapons of war, and leave
them buried. Forgive, and do
that which is harder than to
forgive: **Forget**. And when it
comes to mind again, forget it

President Jeffrey R. Holland
“Remember Lot’s Wife,” Jan
2019
again.”



“You can remember just enough to avoid repeating the mistake, but then...dismiss the destructive and keep dismissing it until the beauty of the Atonement of Christ has revealed to you your bright future and the bright future of your family and your friends and your neighbors. God doesn't care nearly as much about where you have been as He does about where you are and, with His help, where you are willing to go.

President Jeffery R. Holland

“That is the only thing, Lot's wife didn't get.”

2009



“In my best reenactment of Lot’s wife, I said, in effect, ‘Let’s go back. Let’s go home [to St. George]. The future holds nothing for us.’ Then [Pat]...grabbed me by the lapels and said, ‘**We are not going back.** We are not going home. **The future holds everything for us.**’”

President Jeffrey R. Holland
“Remember Lot’s Wife,” Jan

2009

for us



“To all such of every generation, I call out, ‘Remember Lot’s wife.’ Faith is for the future. Faith builds on the past but never longs to stay there.

Faith trusts that God has great things in store for each of us and that Christ truly is the ‘high priest of good things

to come.’ (Hebrews 9:11).”

President Jeffrey R. Holland
“Remember Lot’s Wife,” Jan

2009



The background is a detailed oil painting depicting the biblical story of the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah. The scene is set at night, with a dark, stormy sky filled with swirling clouds and a bright, fiery light emanating from the horizon, suggesting the city's destruction. In the foreground, a large, multi-story building with a prominent tower and a balcony is visible. Several figures are seen on the balcony and on the ground in front of the building. The overall color palette is dominated by dark, earthy tones, with highlights of orange and yellow from the fire in the distance.

Sarah's
Laughte
r

Lot's
Tragedy

God's
Providing



“Take your son,
your only son,
whom you
love—Isaac—and
... sacrifice him^{Gen 22:2,}
as a burnt offering^{NIV}”



“We will worship
and then we will
come back to you.”
Genesis 22:5,

NIV



“Father?... The
fire and wood are
here, but where
is the lamb for
the burnt
offering?”

Genesis 22:5

NIV



“God himself will
provide the lamb
for the burnt
offering, my
son.”

Genesis 22:8,

NIJ

“I’m sending you
to a promised
land.”



“I’m sending you
to a promised
land.”

“Where?”

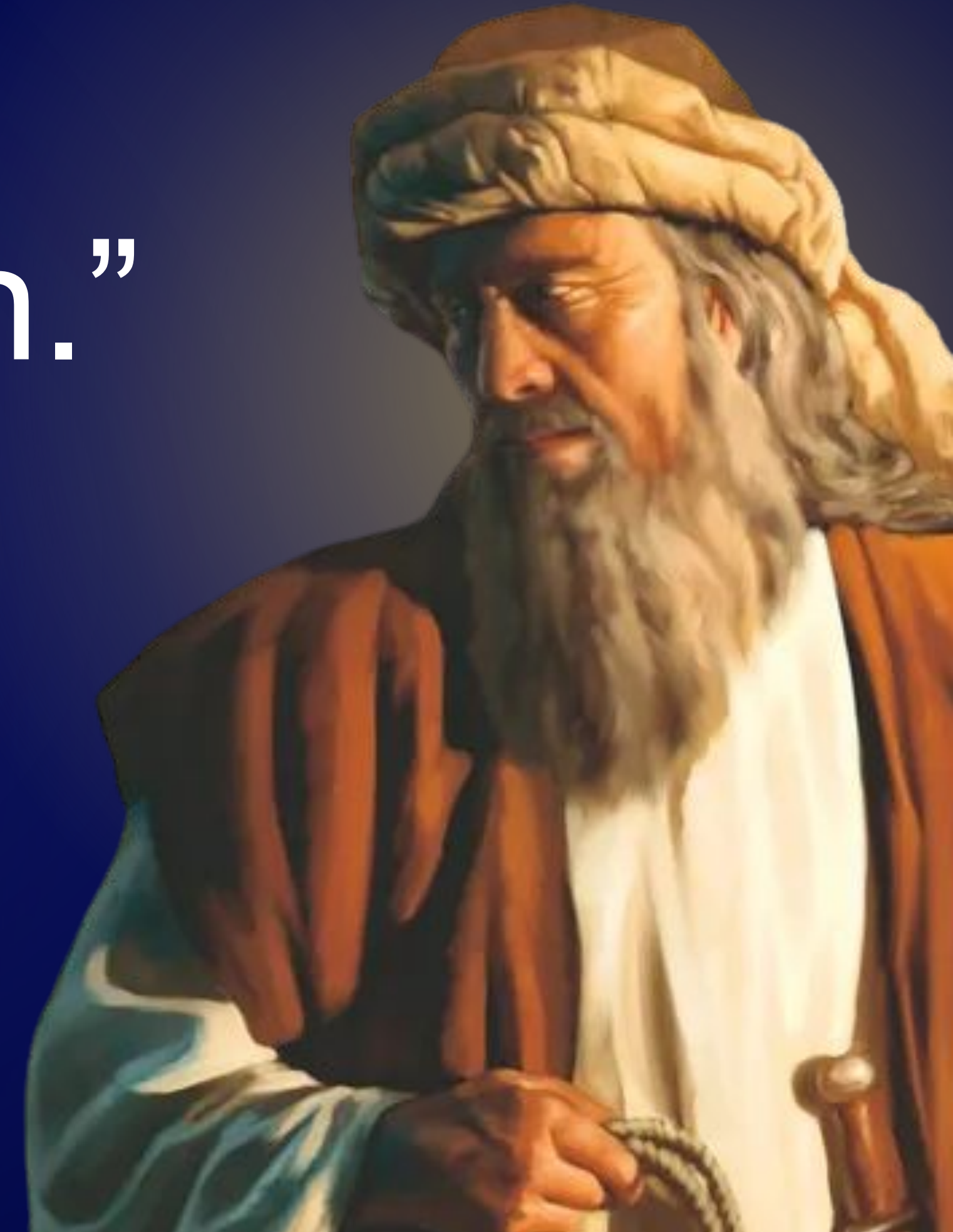


“I’m sending you
to a promised
land.”

“Where?”

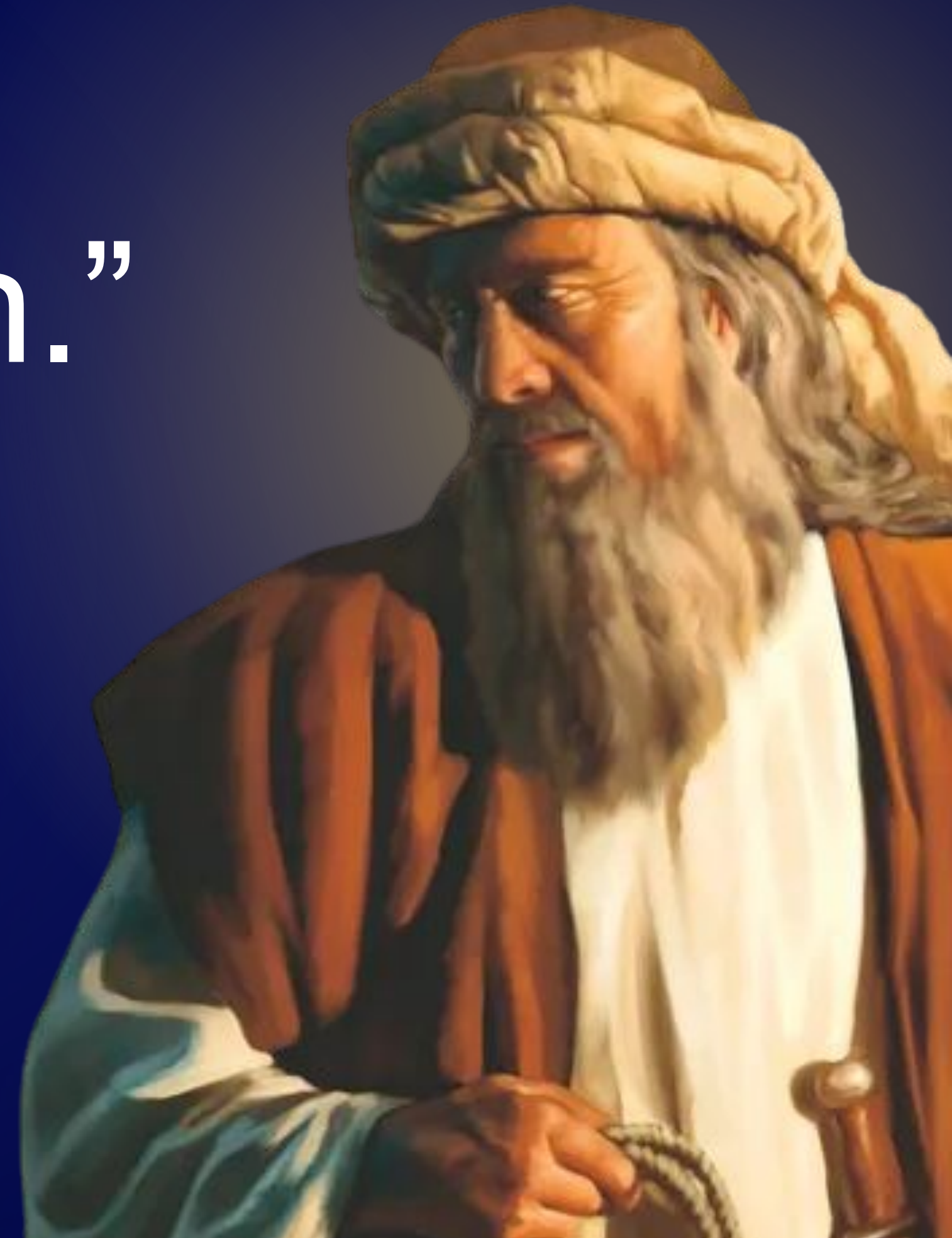


“You’ll have a son.”



“You’ll have a son.”

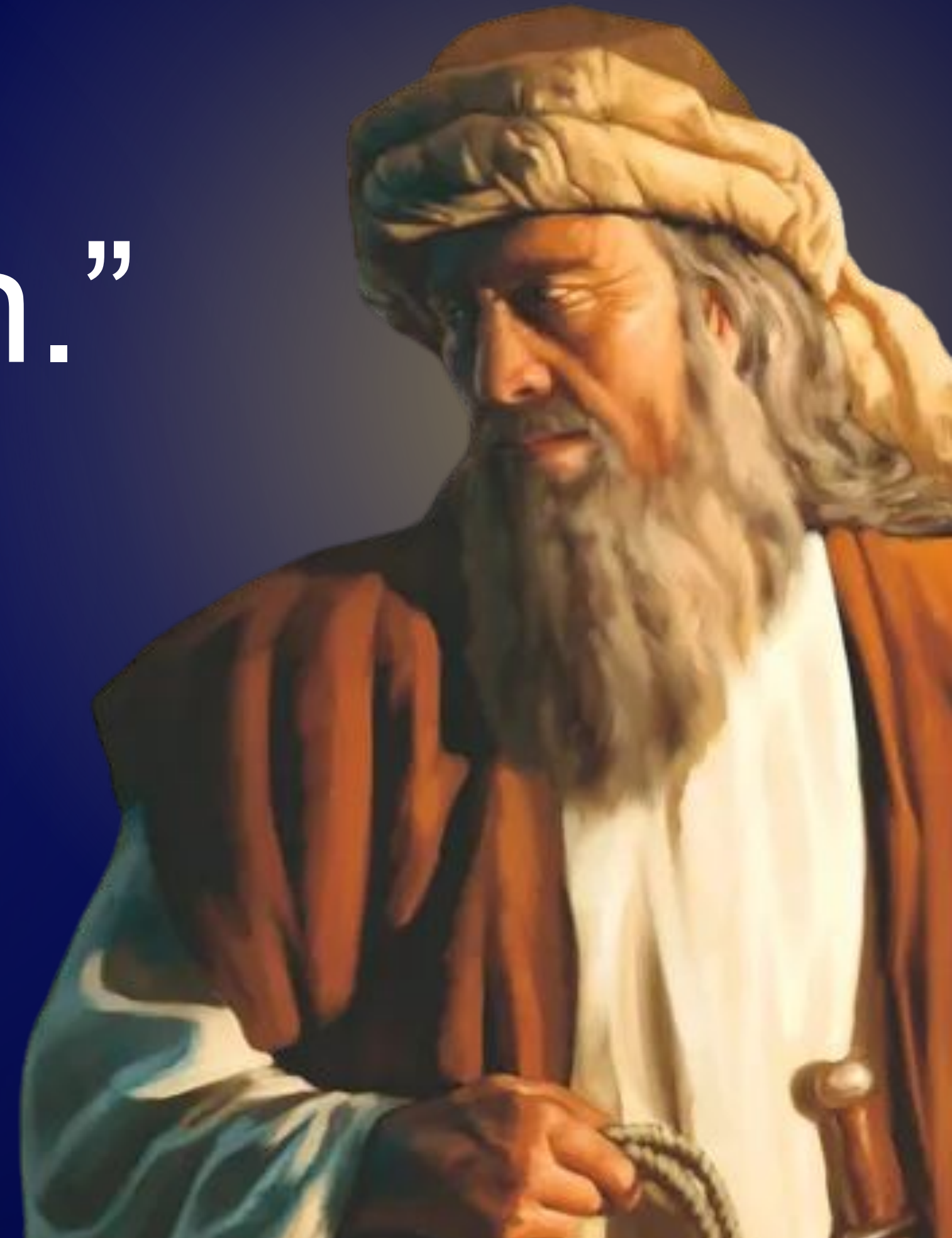
“How?”



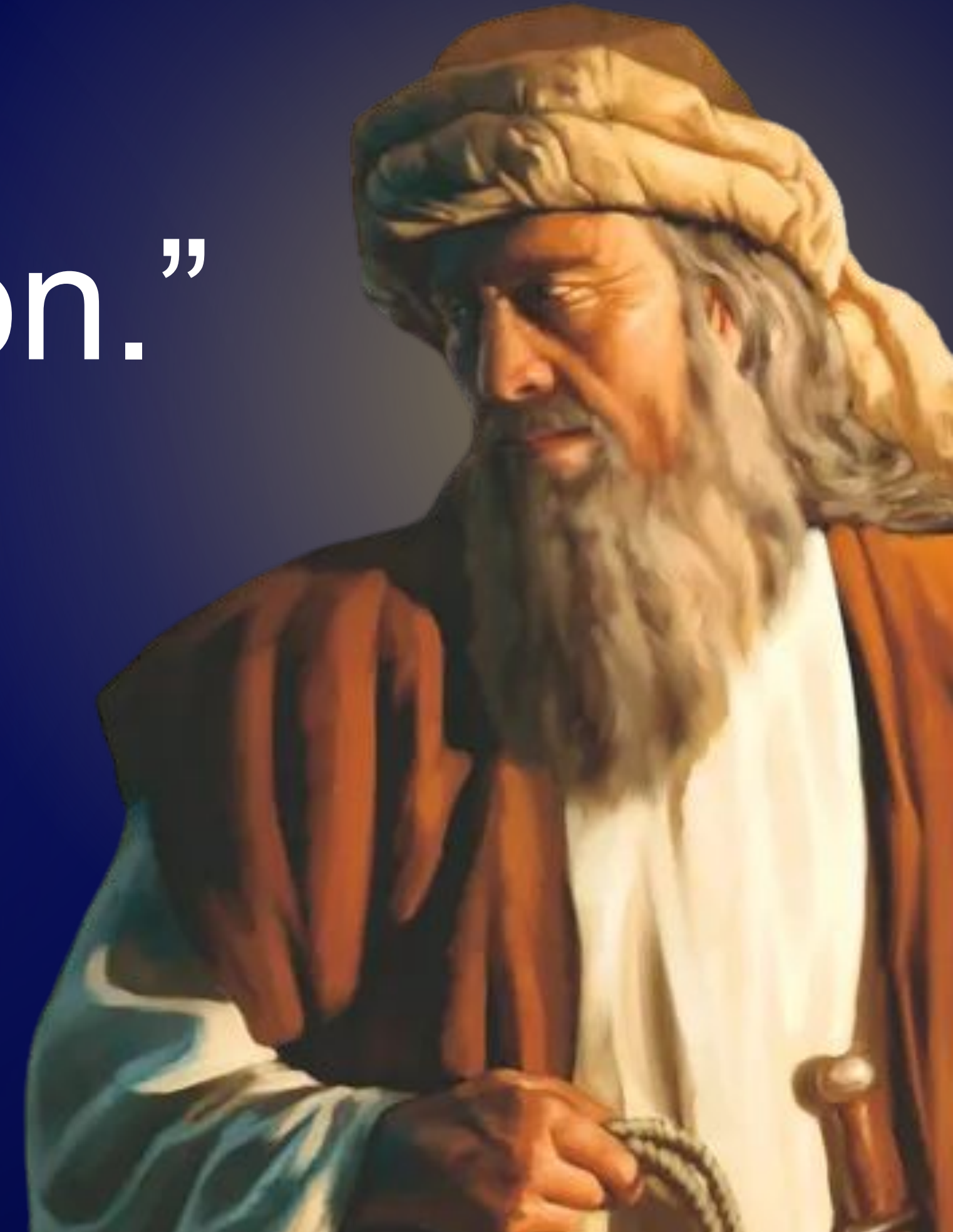
“You’ll have a son.”

“How?”

“I’ll tell you later.”

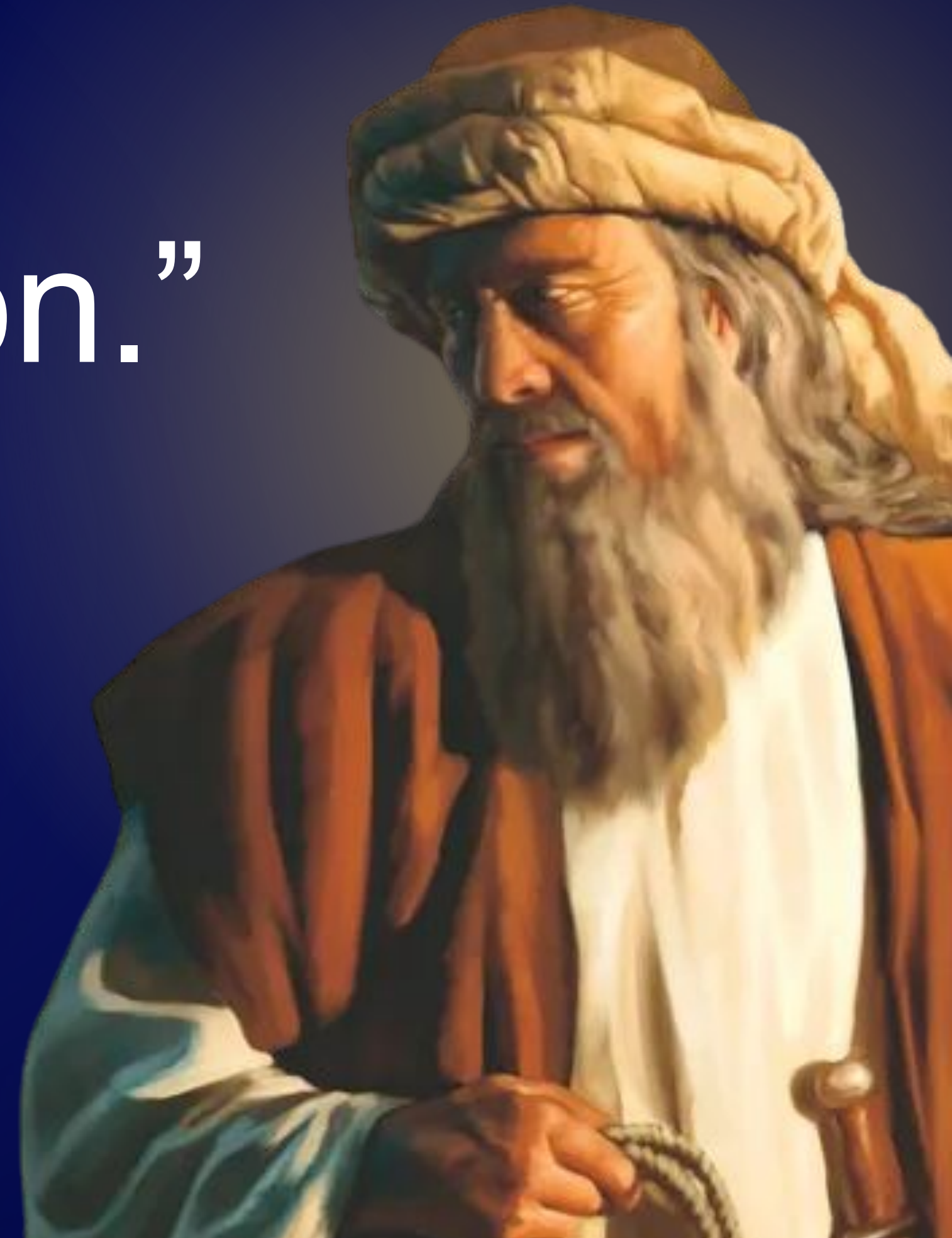


“Sacrifice your son.”



“Sacrifice your son.”

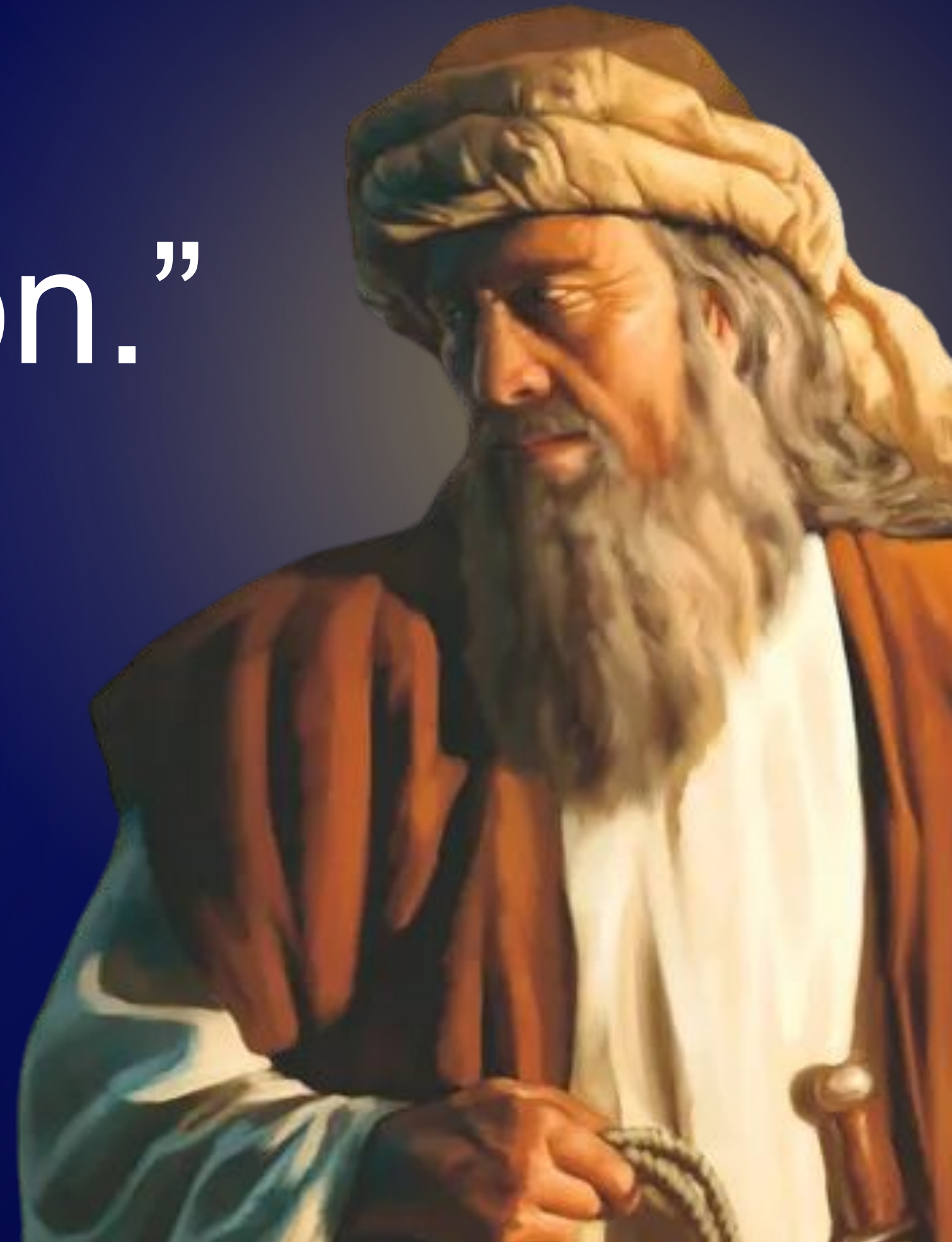
“Why?”

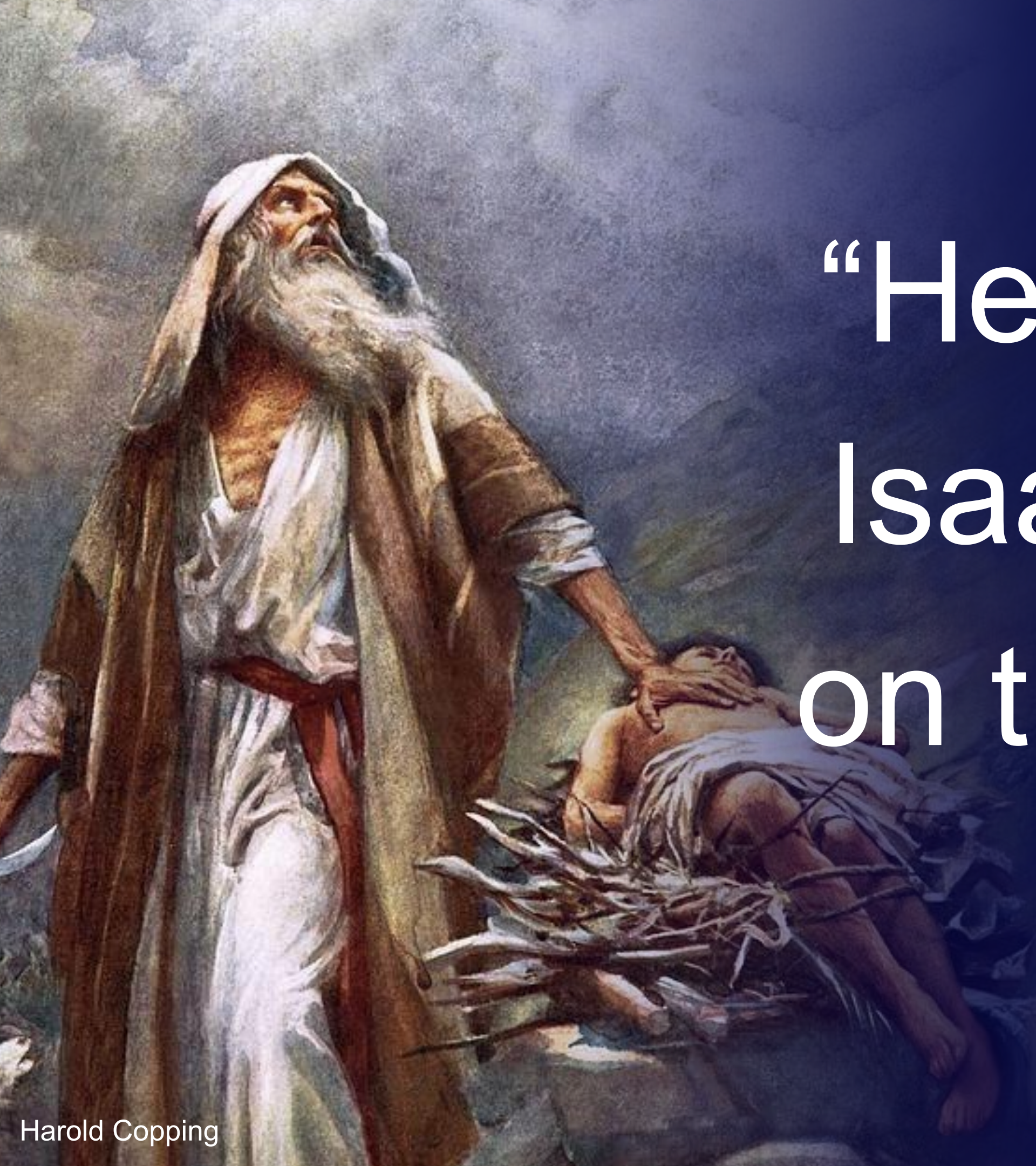


“Sacrifice your son.”

“Why?”

“I’ll tell you later.”

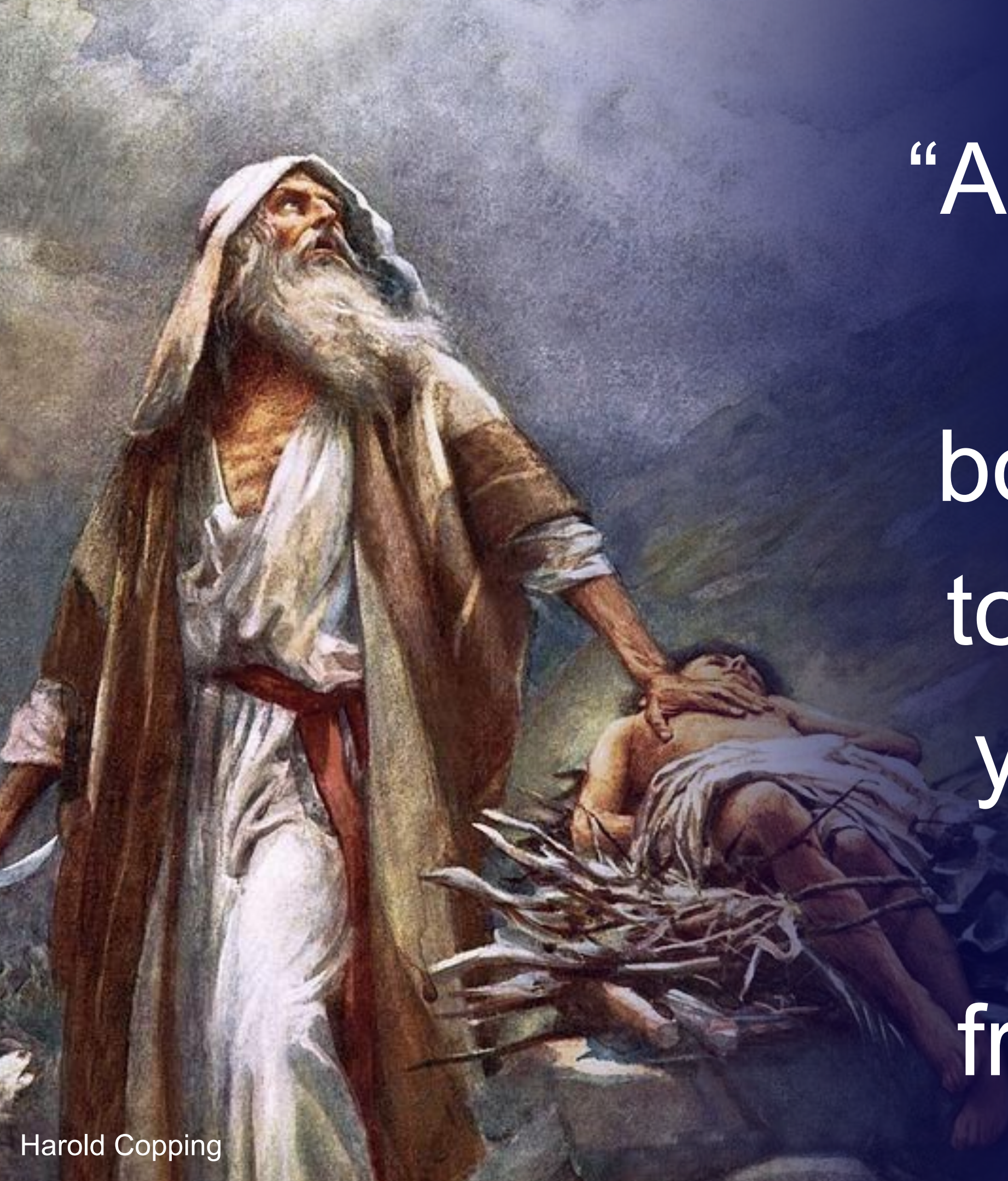




“He bound his son
Isaac and laid him
on the altar, on top
of the wood.”

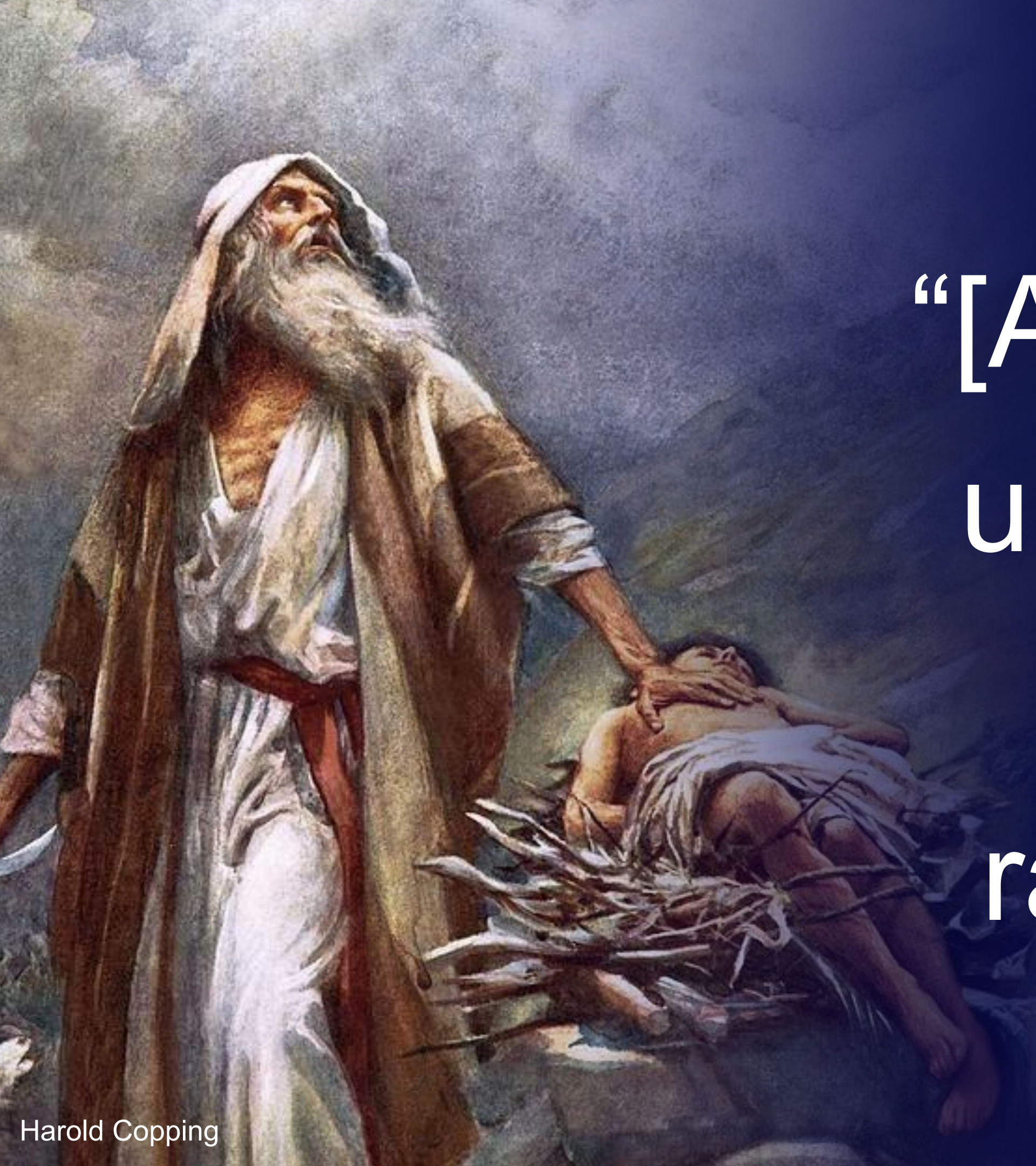
Genesis 22:9,

NIV



“Abraham! Abraham! Do
not lay a hand on the
boy. Do not do anything
to him. Now I know that
you fear God, because
you have not withheld
from me your son, your

Genesis 22:11-12,
NIIV,
only son



“[Abraham] looked
up, and there in a
thicket he saw a
ram caught by its
horns.”

Genesis

22:13

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Typological Foreshadowing (God intended
it)

Typolog

Typological Foreshadowing (God intended
Illustrative Parallels (No obvious
divine or prophetic intent)

Typolog

Typological Foreshadowing (God intended

Illustrative Parallels (No clear divine
or prophetic intent)

False Typology (No actual connection)



“Abraham
[offered]...up his
son Isaac, which is
a similitude of God
and his Only
Begotten Son.”
Jacob 4:5

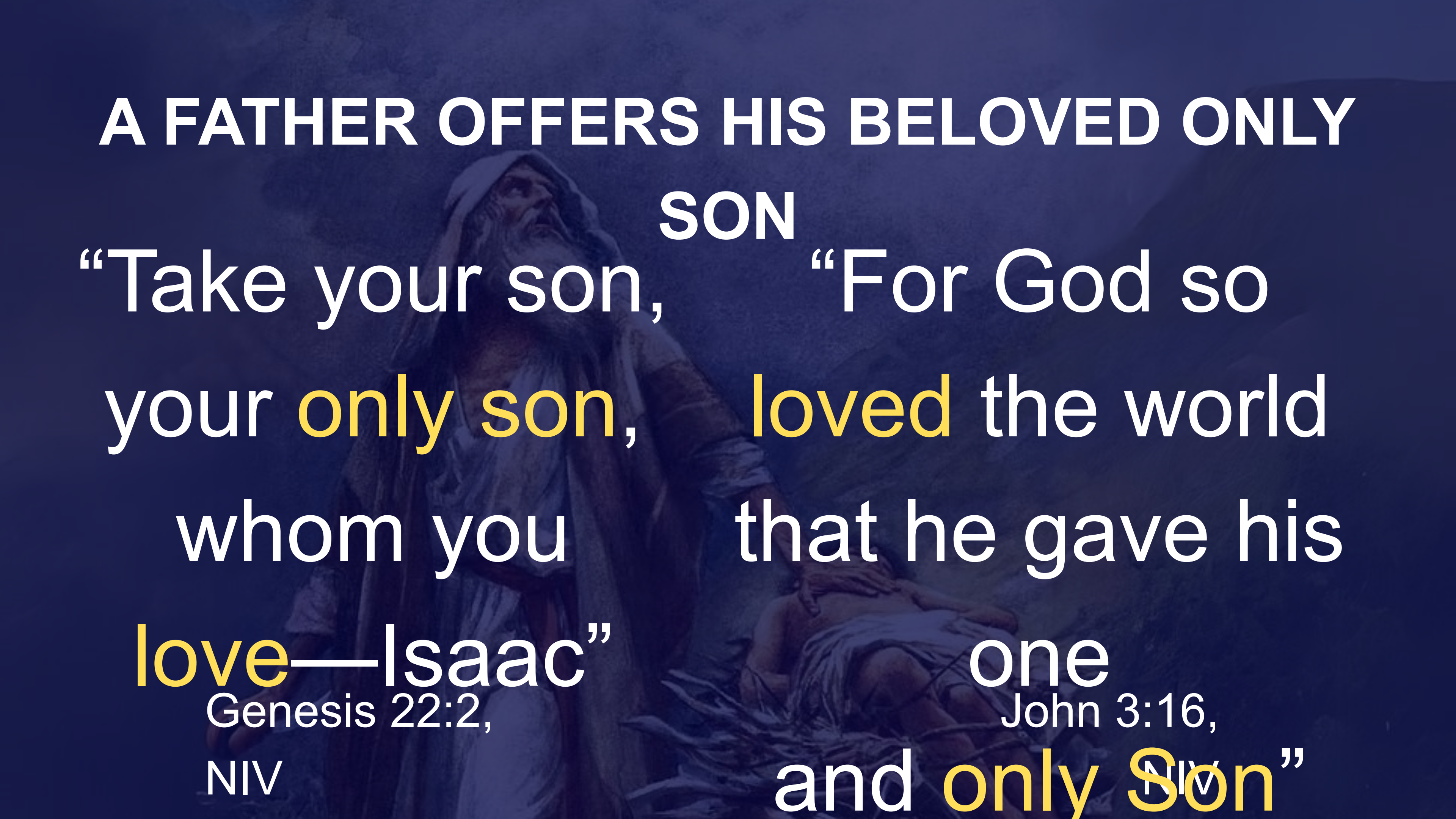
A MIRACULOUS BIRTH

“Will I really
have a child,
now that I am

Genesis 18:13
old?”

“How will this
be, since I am
a **virgin?**”

Luke
1:34



A FATHER OFFERS HIS BELOVED ONLY
SON

“Take your son,
your **only son**,
whom you
loved the world
that he gave his

love—Isaac”

Genesis 22:2,

NIV

one

John 3:16,

and **only Son**”

NIV

CARRYING THE WOOD

“Abraham took
the **wood** for the
burnt offering
and placed it on
his son Isaac”

Genesis 22:6,

NIV

“Carrying his
own **cross**,
[Jesus] went out
to the place of
the **Skull**”

John 19:17,

NIV

A SUBSTITUTE SACRIFICE WAS

PROVIDED

Isaac: A ram

Jesus:

caught in a

Jesus is the

thicket is offered

substitute—f

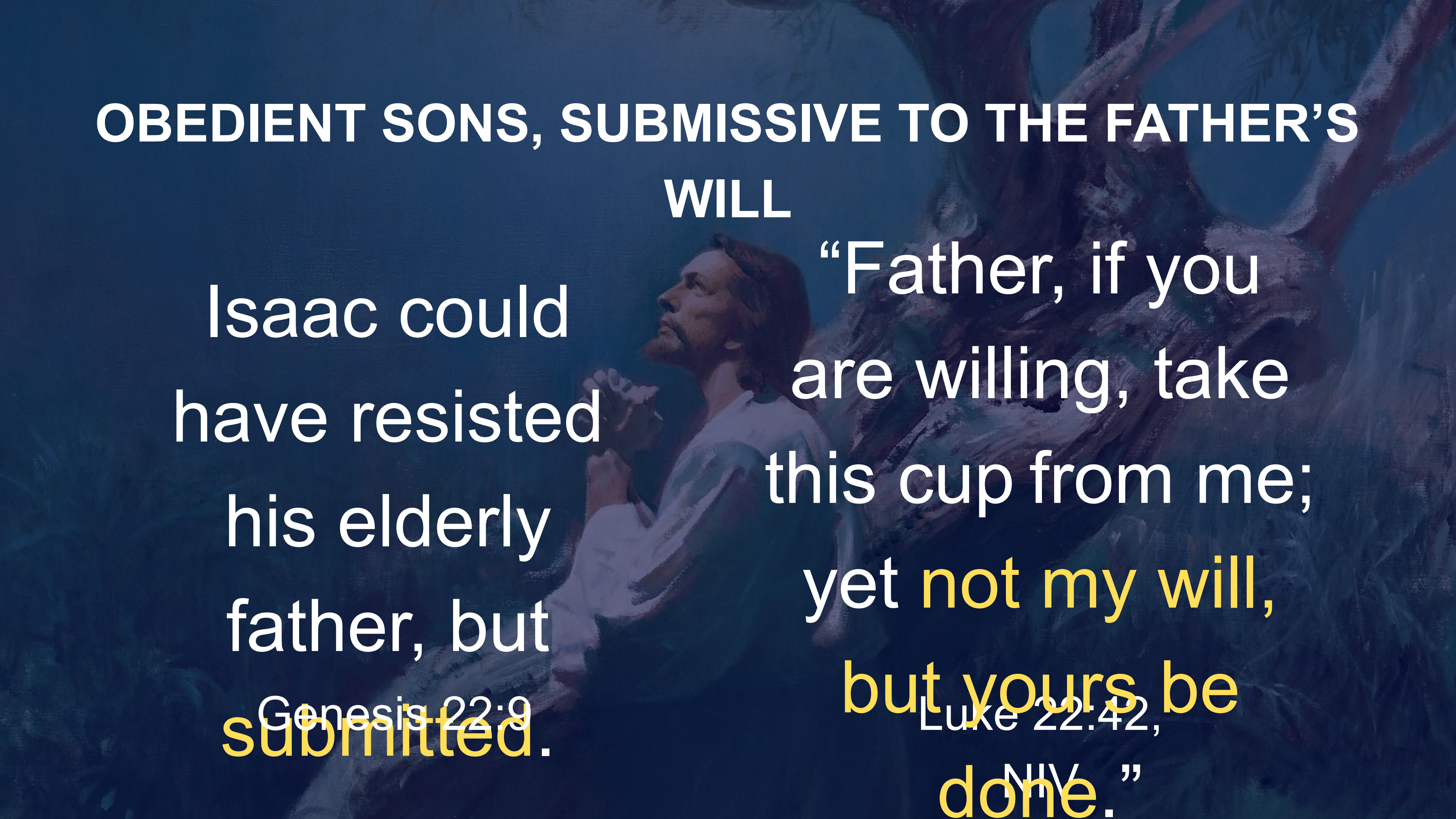
in Isaac's place

or us
John 1:29

Genesis 22:13

1 Peter

1:18–19



OBEDIENT SONS, SUBMISSIVE TO THE FATHER'S WILL

Isaac could
have resisted
his elderly
father, but

Genesis 22:9
submitted.

“Father, if you
are willing, take
this cup from me;
yet **not my will,**
but yours be

Luke 22:42,
NIV.”
done.”

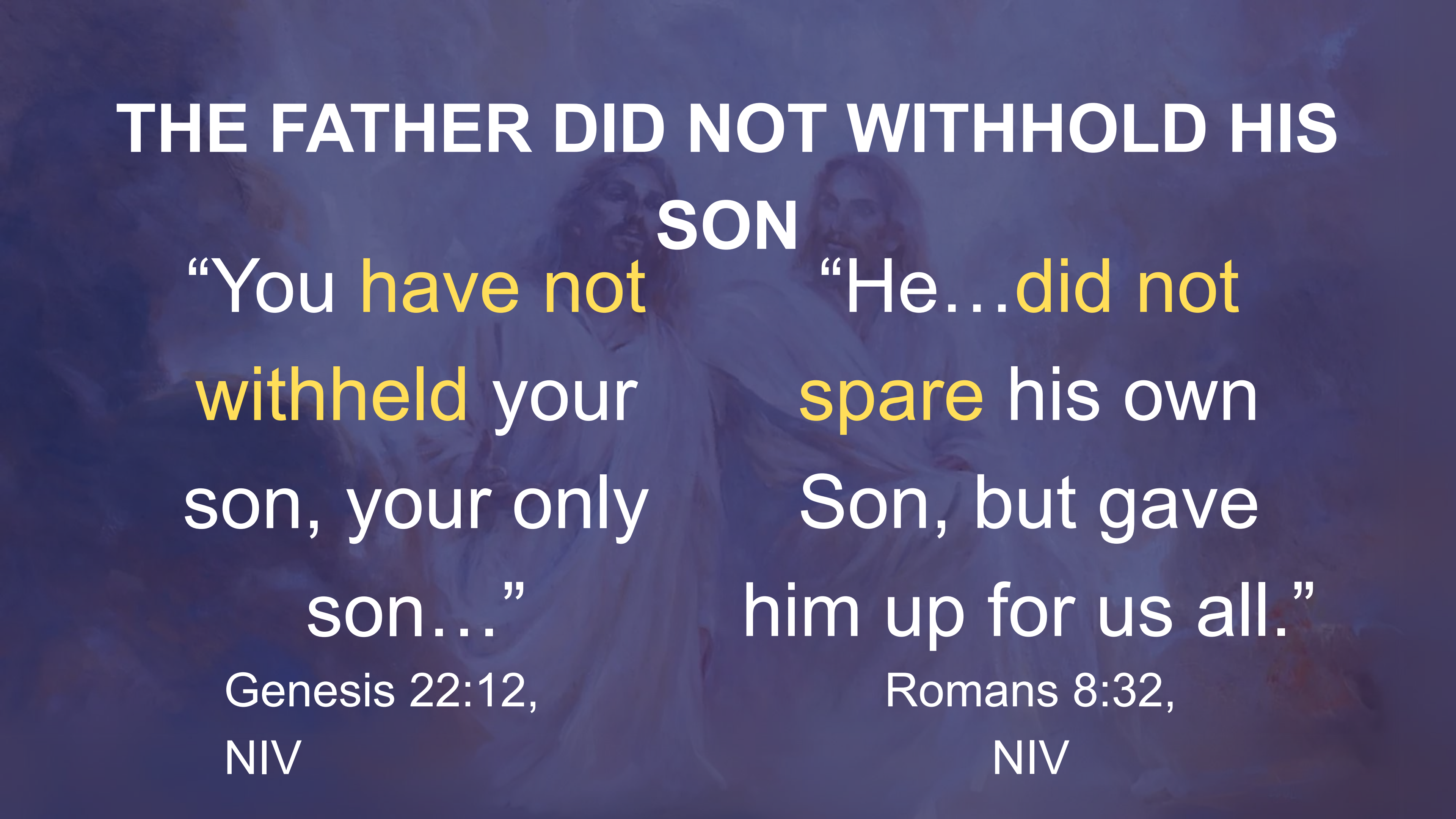
SIMILAR LOCATIONS

“God said... ‘Go to the **region of Moriah**. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain. I will show you.”

Genesis 22:2, NIV

“Solomon began to build the temple of the Lord in Jerusalem on **Mount Moriah**.”

2 Chronicles 3:1
NIV



THE FATHER DID NOT WITHHOLD HIS SON

“You **have not withheld** your son, your only son...”

Genesis 22:12,
NIV

“He...**did not spare** his own Son, but gave him up for us all.”

Romans 8:32,
NIV

“Sarah being silent [in the story of Isaac’s sacrifice is] a type of Mary. She is the mother of the son who’s going to be offered and she’s silent, just like Mary was at the cross...We have to think...about our mothers from the scriptures, what part they played and what they did and how important [they were, even if] we don’t hear [their] voice.”



“Abraham called the name of
that place **Jehovahjireh**...”

Genesis 22:14, KJV

“Abraham called that place
The LORD Will Provide.”

Genesis 22:14, NIV

“God himself will
provide the lamb.”

Genesis 22:8, NIV

Abraham didn't call the
mount, "I will do it,
because I am awesome,"

Abraham didn't call the
mount, "I will do it,
because I am awesome,"
he called it
"God will provide."

Every challenge we face is
an opportunity to trust that
God will provide.



“If Abraham had been at the foot of Calvary the moment Jesus died, do you know what he would have done? He would have taken the words of God to him...and turned them around.”

Timothy J. Keller



“He would have looked up at the Father, and he would have said, ‘Now I know! Now I know that you love me, because you did not withhold your Son, your only Son, whom you love, from me.’ How do you know God loves you and values you...so much that you can really rest in [his love] and be free...? How can you know he loves you like that?”

Timothy J. Keller



“Not by saying, ‘I’m just going to trust in him.’ By the Spirit, you have to see [that] Abraham and Isaac going up the mountain was a picture of the price the Father paid at Calvary. It has to move you, and it has to change you. You have to, from the bottom of your heart by the power of the Spirit, say, ‘Now I know! Now I know that you love me, because you gave your Son. You did not

Timothy J. Keller

“Real Faith and the Only Son,” June 17, 2001

2001



Insights from, discussions with, and resources authored by President Jeffrey R. Holland, Timothy Keller, President Russell M. Nelson, Jo Ann Seely, Stephan Taeger, and Robert Zajonc were used in the creation of this video.

See further acknowledgements at

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